Cetuximab + cisplatin + fluorouracil

Cetuximab with cisplatin and fluorouracil is used to treat squamous head and neck cancer. Discuss the individual aim, likely benefit, symptom control and alternatives with your oncology team.

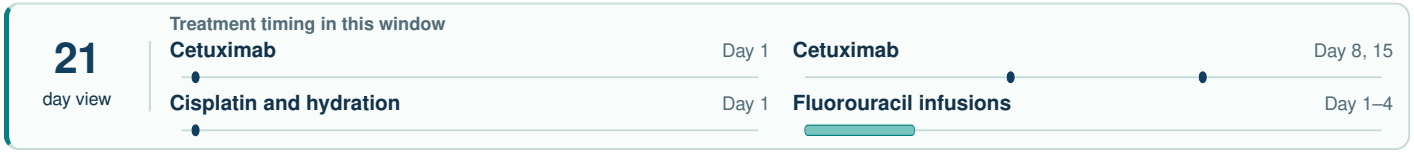
Treatment of locally advanced or metastatic squamous cell cancer of the head and neck. · NCCP 00417 v7 · Document revised 10 November 2026

Your personal plan: this is the standard regimen schedule. Your team confirms your prescribed doses, cycles, treatment changes and appointments in your written plan.

Treatment of locally advanced or metastatic squamous cell cancer of the head and neck.

My overall treatment

Every 21 days for up to 6 combination cycles; cetuximab is weekly.



Combination cycles

Day 1: cetuximab plus platinum; Days 1–4: fluorouracil; Days 8 and 15: cetuximab. Up to 6 cycles.

After the combination

Cetuximab alone may be considered under a separate agreed maintenance plan.

A typical 21-day cycle

Day 1–4	Day 5–15	Day 16–21
Combination and fluorouracil days	Recovery plus weekly cetuximab	Prepare the next cycle

Timing may change after review. Side effects can occur on any day; there are no guaranteed safe days.

My tests and checks

When	What is checked	Timing / reason
Before	**Safety and preparation** NCCP / individual plan	Blood count, kidney/liver tests, magnesium and dihydropyrimidine dehydrogenase (a medicine-processing enzyme) (DPD); allergy history. electrocardiogram (ECG), hearing and kidney clearance when indicated.
During	**Blood tests and symptoms** NCCP	Blood count, kidney/liver tests and magnesium each cycle; symptom review before weekly visits.
After / response	**Follow-up and assessment** NCCP / individual plan	Magnesium, calcium and electrolytes monthly for 2 months after last cetuximab; scans follow your plan.

Between treatments

- Daily 22-hour fluorouracil on Days 1–4, or 2,000 mg/m² over 46–48 hours twice as prescribed; confirm changes and completion.
- Report fever or sudden illness promptly. Follow the written support plan; do not wait for the next visit if symptoms worsen.

Bring your medicines list, appointment calendar, test results and verified urgent contacts.

When to get help

Call 112 / 999 for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

Call oncology immediately: temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.

Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.

What to watch for

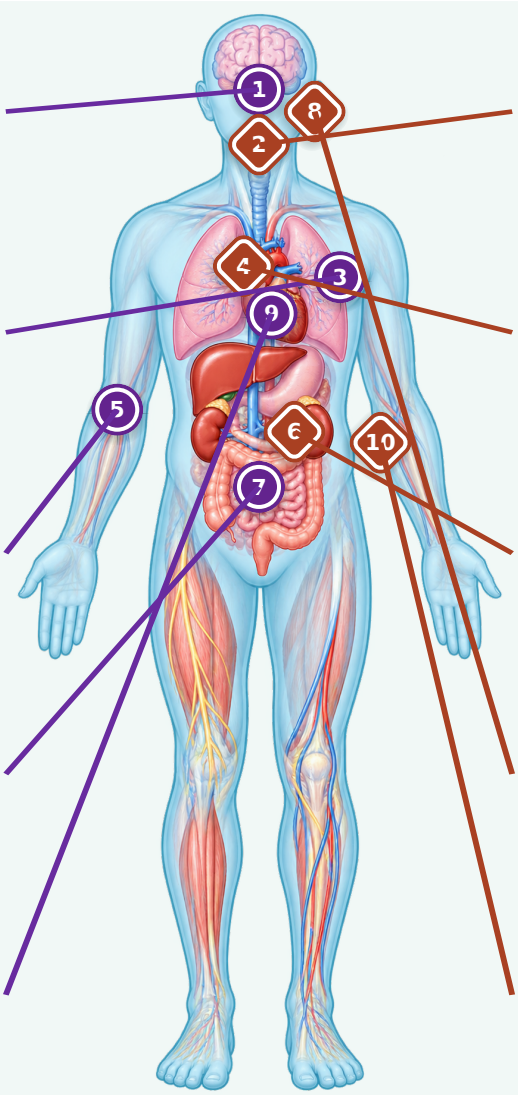
You do not need to know which medicine caused a symptom before calling.

1 Eyes
Cetuximab
Report painful or red eyes, light sensitivity or a change in vision promptly.

2 Mouth / swallowing
Fluorouracil
Report ulcers, painful swallowing or difficulty drinking; early severe symptoms need urgent review.

3 Lungs / breathing
Cetuximab
Report new cough or breathlessness. Wheeze, swelling or faintness may be an infusion reaction.

4 Heart / chest
Fluorouracil
Chest pain, tightness, palpitations or collapse needs urgent assessment during or after an infusion.



5 Skin / nails / hands / feet
Cetuximab + fluorouracil
Report rash, cracked skin, painful nails or sore palms/soles. Spreading redness, pus or fever needs early review.

6 Minerals / fluids
Cisplatin + cetuximab
Kidney and mineral tests matter. Report reduced urine, cramps, marked weakness or palpitations.

7 Bowels / hydration
Fluorouracil
Call early for diarrhoea, severe tummy pain, dizziness or inability to keep fluids down.

8 Hearing / balance
Cisplatin
Report tinnitus, hearing loss or balance change before another dose; some changes may persist.

9 Blood cells / infection
Chemotherapy
Fever, shivering, sudden illness, unusual bruising or bleeding needs prompt oncology advice.

10 Infusion / access site
Cetuximab + chemotherapy
Tell staff about itching, swelling, wheeze or faintness immediately. Delayed reactions can occur after leaving.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Call oncology immediately for fever, shivering, sudden illness, persistent vomiting, diarrhoea, severe mouth pain or inability to drink. Chest pain during or after fluorouracil, or unusually early severe symptoms, needs urgent assessment even if DPD testing was normal. Report breathing difficulty, swelling, faintness, spreading skin infection or painful eyes promptly. Severe chest pain, severe breathing difficulty, collapse or a seizure is an emergency.

When to get help

Call 112 / 999 for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

Call oncology immediately: temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

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Keep your treatment details to hand

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Print this page **one-sided on A4 at Actual size / 100%**. Cut only the dashed outer border around both panels. **Do not cut the centre line.** Fold with FRONT and BACK facing out, then glue or tape the blank backs together. Finished size: **85.6 × 54 mm**. Keep the stamp side writable.

FRONT / CONTACTS

My Treatment Card

SACTCheck

Name: _____

Cetuximab + cisplatin + fluorouracil

Every 21 days for up to 6 combination cycles; cetuximab is weekly.

Phase: _____ Planned cycles: 6

Daytime (EXAMPLE) 087 12345678
Out of hours (EXAMPLE) 087 87654321

Unwell or fever? Call oncology now.
Severe breathing difficulty, chest pain or collapse: **112 / 999.**

EXAMPLE NUMBERS — replace before patient use.

CUT outer border

BACK / TREATMENT RECORD

My cycle record

Team stamps after each completed cycle.

C1	C2	C3	
Date / initials	Date / initials	Date / initials	My treatment information
C4	C5	C6	
Date / initials	Date / initials	Date / initials	

Plan changed? Ask the team to update this card.

FOLD centre — do not cut

Keep the record accurate

The team dates and initials each recorded treatment unit when complete. A cycle is complete after its final planned dose; a weekly-treatment stamp records that weekly dose. Delays, omitted doses or a changed plan need a note or a replacement card. A stamp does not approve the next treatment. Keep any medicine-specific alert card too.

Put your treatment page on your phone

Scan your QR and check the treatment name. Save that page to your home screen.

iPhone / Safari

Tap Share → Add to Home Screen. Select Open as Web App if offered, then Add.

Android / Chrome

Tap the three-dot menu → Add to Home screen or Install and create shortcut. Choose the shortcut option and confirm.

Menu wording varies. The QR opens information, not a personal record. Paper stamps do not update the website. Check that the saved icon opens the correct treatment.

Your local contacts and resources

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.

Hospital / team: _____
Backup if the team cannot be reached: _____

Additional local services and resources will be added when confirmed. Your team must check and complete this page before patient use.

Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.